Daniel J. Sonnenstuhl

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Employment

Research Economist, Nclusion — July 2026–

Education

University of Chicago, PhD. Public Policy (Economics) — 2020–2026
University College London, MSc. Economics, *Distinction* — 2017–2018
University College London, BA. Philosophy and Economics, *First Class Honors* — 2014–2017

Publications

"A Denial a Day Keeps the Doctor Away" (with Abe Dunn, Joshua D. Gottlieb, Adam Hale Shapiro and Pietro Tebaldi)
The Quarterly Journal of Economics, 139(1): 187–233, February 2024.

Working Papers

"Working Without Wages: The Consequences of Widespread Pay Delays" (with Dauda Musa)

Work in Progress

"The Economics of Wage Withholding: Evidence from Nigerian Firms" (with Dauda Musa)

"The Causes and Implications of the Pentecostal Movement: Evidence from Nigeria"

"Megachurches and Religious Messaging in Nigeria" (with Olaitan Ogunnote)

"Pentecostalism and Social Cooperation: The Big Gods Hypothesis in Action" (with Olaitan Ogunnote)

Research Grants (Total funding received as PI or co-PI: ∼$300,000)

Private Enterprise Development in Low-Income Countries (PEDL)
- Exploratory Research Grant (£40,000) — 2026
- Seed Grant, with Nofiu Adebisi and George Agyeah (£5,000) — 2023

The Weiss Fund
- Research Grant ($50,000) — 2024
- Pilot Grant, with Olaitan Ogunnote ($15,000) — 2024
- Pilot Grant ($11,500) — 2024
- Exploratory Grant ($3,500) — 2023

Development Economics Center at Becker Friedman Institute
- Research Grant ($30,000) — 2025
- Research Grant ($25,000) — 2024
- Pilot Grant ($10,000) — 2024
- Exploratory Grant ($5,000) — 2023
- Pilot Grant ($10,000) — 2023
- Exploratory Grant ($5,000) — 2022

Becker Friedman Institute
Data Acquisition Grant ($18,100) 2025

Structural Transformation and Economic Growth (STEG)
PhD Student Research Grant (£15,000) 2024

The Pearson Institute
Small Research Grant, with Dauda Musa ($5,000) 2025
Small Research Grant ($10,000) 2023

The Center for Effective Global Action (CEGA)
Seed Grant, with Olaitan Ogunnote ($10,639) 2024

Becker Friedman Institute Political Economics Initiative
Small Research Grant ($5,000) 2023

Fellowships and Awards

Harris Graduate Student Fellowship 2020–2026
Erste Bank Group Scholarship 2015

Research Experience

Pre-Doctoral Fellow, University of Chicago, Booth School of Business Feb 2020–Sept 2020
Pre-Doctoral Fellow, University of British Columbia, Vancouver School of Economics Oct 2018–Jan 2020

Invited Seminars (including scheduled)

2025: Leibniz Institute for Economic Research (Berlin), STEG Early Career Workshop
2024: Covenant University

Conference Presentations (including scheduled)

2026: PacDev, Institute for Humane Studies Workshop, MWIEDC, NOVAFRICA, GDE/EDEG
2025: CSAE, DevPEC, EEA Meeting, Advances with Field Experiments Conference
2024: ASREC, SIOE, RES PhD Conference